Dario Trujano-Ochoa

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Research Fields

Primary: Experimental and Behavioral Economics

Secondary: Information and Uncertainty; Agricultural, Environmental, and Consumer Economics; Economics of Education

Topics: Learning, belief updating, and information acquisition under risk • Financial education • Nature exposure, cognitive load, and strategic thinking • Food choice and consumer behavior

Education

Ph.D. in Economics
University of California Santa Barbara (USA) *2019-2025*
Dissertation: Three Studies in Experimental Economics, Committee: Daniel Martin (co-chair), Gary Charness (co-chair in memoriam) Erik Eyster and Ignacio Esponda.

M.Sc. in Economics
Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas (Mexico City) *2015-2017*
Thesis: "Quantal Response Equilibrium in a Citizen-Candidate Experiment", Committee: Alexander Elbittar (chair), Hernan Bejarano and Luz Marina Arias

Specialty in Applied Statistics
Universidad Nacional Autónoma de Mexico (Mexico City) *2013- 2014*
Instituto de Investigaciones en Matemáticas Aplicadas y en Sistemas

Bachelor of Psychology (with distinction)
Universidad Nacional Autónoma de Mexico, Facultad de Psicología (Mexico City) *2008-2013*
Thesis: "La Teoría del Prospecto en la Predicción de Estrategias Mixtas en un juego 2x2", Committee: Arturo Bouzas (director), Oscar Zamora Arevalo (reviewer), Florente Lopez Rodriguez, German Palafox and Oscar Vladimir Orduna Trujillo.

References

Daniel Martin
Dissertation Chair
Associate Professor of Economics
University of California, Santa Barbara
danielmartin@ucsb.edu

Erik Eyster
Dissertation Committee
Professor of Economics
University of California, Santa Barbara
erikeyster@ucsb.edu

Marco A. Palma
Postdoctoral Supervisor
Professor of Agricultural Economics
Director, Human Behavior Laboratory
Texas A&M University
marco.palma@ag.tamu.edu

Job Market Paper

Differing Priors and Information Acquisition When Others Make the Decision
Job Market Paper [PDF]
Does it matter who acts on information you buy? In a lab experiment, I find that when priors differ, people value information more when they make the decision themselves. This control premium is driven by non-Bayesian updating projected onto others.

Academic Positions

Postdoctoral Researcher
Department of Agricultural Economics, Texas A&M AgriLife Research *Spring 2025–Present*
Human Behavior Laboratory, Supervisor: Marco A. Palma. Incentivized laboratory and field experiments with eye tracking and galvanic skin response • Nature exposure, cognitive performance, and strategic thinking (Plants, Nature and Health Initiative; field experiment at the Texas A&M Research Park) • Healthy food choices and cognitive load in real-effort tasks • Grant proposal to the Horticultural Research Institute (submitted)

Publications

Effects of a Brief Childhood Financial Education Intervention in Latin America (with María Teresa Borja Chico, Eduardo Rocha Torres, and Jessica Maricarmen Serrano Bandala)
Revista de Educación Superior del Sur Global, forthcoming 2026.

Citizen Candidates in the Lab: Rules, Costs, and Positions (with Alexander Elbittar and Andrei Gomberg)
Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, 2024. [Paper]

Learning Your Own Risk Preferences (with Gary Charness and Nir Chemaya)
Journal of Risk and Uncertainty, 2023. [Paper]

The Role of Cognitive and Personality Characteristics in Timely Microcredit Repayment: Evidence from a Survey Conducted by Provident, Mexico (with Sonia Di Giannatale, Daniel Ventosa-Santaulària, María José Roa, and Alexander Elbittar)
Ensayos Revista de Economía, 2020. [Paper]

Working Papers

High Stakes and Distractions: The Source of Cognitive Load and its Effect on Real Effort Performance
With Brian A. Toney, Andreas C. Drichoutis, and Marco A. Palma

Healthy Food Choices in Surveys and the Field: Evidence on Messages and Menu Design
With Marissa Lepper, Paul Feldman, and Marco Palma

The Effect of Feedback on News-Verification Demand: Experimental Evidence
With Jose Gloria

Replication Report of "Belief Elicitation and Behavioral Incentive Compatibility" by Danz, Vesterlund, and Wilson (2022)
With Zeeshan Samad

Work in Progress

Does Financial Education Work in Primary School?
With Arcelia Rodríguez Aguirre

Do Liars Prefer to Tell One Big Lie or Multiple Small Lies?
With Pablo Soto-Mota and Jareef Martuza

Overconfidence and Fact-Checking in the Philippines
With Jose Gloria

Teaching

Courses Taught as Instructor

University of California Santa Barbara **(UCSB, USA)**
Three different quarters, developed course material with John Hartman *2023*
Statistics for Economics (Undergraduate)

Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México **(UNAM, Mexico)**
Six summer workshops (12-20 hours each), Independently developed course material *2012-2017*
Microeconomics: What every psychologist must know, Mathematical Statistics for psychologist, Introduction to Game Theory, Game Theory and Cooperation, Graphs with R, Introduction to R (Undergraduate).

Teaching Assistant

University of California Santa Barbara **(UCSB, USA)**
Twelve quarters *2019 - 2025*
Statistics for Economics, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Financial Management, History of Economic Thought, Introduction to Game Theory (Undergraduate)

Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas **(CIDE, Mexico)**
Two Semesters *2017*
Advanced Microeconomics (Undergraduate), Econometrics: Teaching Assistant (PhD in Public Policy)

Presentations at Conferences and Seminars

Information Acquisition When Others Make the Decision **Los Angeles, CA**
Economic Science Association *July 2026*
World Meeting

Can Financial Education Work in Primary School? **Los Angeles, CA**
Economic Science Association *July 2026*
World Meeting

Do we know the value of information? **Dearborn, MI**
Society for the Advancement of Behavioral Economics *June 2026*
SABE Annual Conference

Willingness to Verify News Headlines: Experimental Evidence from Mexico **Dearborn, MI**
Society for the Advancement of Behavioral Economics *June 2026*
SABE Annual Conference

The Effect of Feedback on News-Verification Demand **Baylor University, TX**
Texas Experimental Association Symposium *April 2025*

Behavioral Biases on Misinformation **Columbus, OH**
Economic Science Association *October 2024*
North American Meeting

¿Cuándo verificamos las noticias? **México City**
Facultad de Economía, UNAM *September 2024*
Seminario de Investigación en Ciencias del Comportamiento

Do Others Learn Like Me? Higher Order Willingness to Pay for Information **Pasadena, CA**
Caltech *June 2024*
Post-School Behavioral/Experimental Workshop

Do Others Believe the Same? Experimental Analysis of Higher-Order Learning and WTP for Information **Charlotte, NC**
Economic Science Association *October 2023*
North American Meeting

Learning your own risk aversion **Santa Barbara, CA**
Economic Science Association *October 2022*
North American Meeting

Guest Speaker

Toma de decisiones bajo incertidumbre **Museo Interactivo de Economía**
Diplomado en Economía del Comportamiento y sus Aplicaciones *July 2026 (3 hours)*

How much do people pay to know? A behavioral Perspective **Texas A&M University**
Research Methodology *April 2026 (1 hour)*

Willingness to Pay for Information: Experimental Evidence **Texas A&M University**
Food Economics and Policy *October 2025 (1 hour)*

¿Cuánto pagar por descubrir? **UNAM**
Facultad de Psicología *September 2024 (1 hour)*
Unidad de Desarrollo de Materiales de Enseñanza y Apropiación Tecnológica

Training / Summer Schools

14th BESLAB Experimental Economics Summer School in Macroeconomics **Berlin, Germany**
Technische Universitat Berlin, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, and Joachim Herz Stiftung *June 2022*

Fellowships, Honors and Awards

CONAHCYT Scholarship Program for Graduate Studies Abroad
Consejo Nacional de Humanidades, Ciencias y Tecnologías *2024*

Research Quarter Fellowship
UCSB, Department of Economics *Spring 2024*

Fulbright-Garcia Robles
Fulbright Fellowship *2019-2021*

Distinction: Microeconomics Preliminary Exam
UCSB *2020*

CONACYT Postgraduate Scholarship
Consejo Nacional de Ciencia y Tecnología *2015-2017*

Grants

Research Grant (submitted)
Horticultural Research Institute, $33,500 requested *2026*

Department Domestic Travel Grant
UCSB, Department of Economics, $450 *2023, 2024*

Short-Term Research Stay
Alianza MX, University of California, $4,100 *2024*

Doctoral Student Travel Grant
UCSB, Academic Senate, $900 total *2023, 2024*

Research Funding for Experiments
UCSB, Department of Economics, $3,500 *2023*

Department Domestic Travel Grant
UCSB, Department of Economics, $530 *2023, 2024*

Professional Experience

Research

Research Intern
Directorate of Financial Education and Cultural Promotion, Bank of Mexico *Summer 2023*
Summer Intern Research Program (PIV). Supervisor: Jessica Serrano

Research Assistant
Association of Supervisors of Banks of the Americas *2018-2019*
Supervisor: Rudy Araujo

Junior Researcher
Laboratorio Nacional de Políticas Públicas *2017-2018*
Supervisor: Margarita Gomez

Government

Subdirector of Economic Competition Analysis
Instituto Federal de Telecomunicaciones *2018*

Half-time Appointments

Head Teaching Assistant. ECON 5: Statistics for Economics
University of California Santa Barbara *Winter 2024, Fall 2024*
Managing TAs and coordinating with insrtructors in classes of 350 and 650 students

Research Assistant **Professor Sevgi Yuksel**
Economics Department, UCSB *2021*
Implementation and payment of an online experiment on the Base Rate Neglect effect.

Research Assistant **Professor Alexander Elbittar**
Economics Division,CIDE *2016-2017*
Data analysis of laboratory and field experiments

Research Assistant **Professor Arturo Bouzas Riaño**
Laboratory of Behavior and Adaptation, UNAM *2012-2015*
Work in the projects: Learning in Dynamic Environments and Risk Behavior: Election Models Evaluation

Service

Reviewer for: *Judgment and Decision Making*, *Heliyon*, *Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics*, *Economics Letters*, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*.

Mentor: Undergraduate Student Research
Chicano Studies Institute, UCSB. *Fall 2024*

Mentor: Undergraduate Student Research
Instructor for Econ 199A, UCSB. *Spring 2024*

Mentor: First-year PhD Student
Mentorship program at UCSB Department of Economics. *2020-2024*

Organizer: Mentorship Program at UCSB Department of Economics
Organizing and coordinating the mentorship matching and job market talks. *2021*

Memberships

Member of the Economic Science Association
2021-2026

Member of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association
2025

Skills/Programming

Lab methods: Eye tracking, galvanic skin response (GSR/EDA) with iMotions, incentivized laboratory and field experiments.

Experiments: oTree, Qualtrics, Prolific.

R: RStudio, tidyverse, ggplot2, tidymodels (recipes).

Other: Stata, MATLAB, Julia, Gretl, Python, Java, HTML.

Languages: English and Spanish; Learning Portuguese.